

Northwind Retail Co.

Vendor Routing & Compliance Guide

Version 2025.2 — Effective September 1, 2025

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE. Northwind Retail Co. is a fictional retailer. This document was written to test Coreframe Comply and does not describe any real retailer's requirements.

1 General Requirements

1.1 Scope

This guide applies to all merchandise shipped to Northwind distribution centers (DCs). Vendors are responsible for the compliance of any third-party logistics provider acting on their behalf.

1.2 Compliance Program

Non-compliance results in chargebacks as described in Section 9. Chargebacks are deducted from vendor invoices. Chargeback disputes must be submitted through the Vendor Portal within 30 days of the chargeback notice.

Merchandise must be packed to withstand normal handling in transit.

2 Advance Ship Notice (ASN)

2.1 ASN Requirement

Vendors must transmit an EDI 856 Advance Ship Notice for every shipment.

2.2 ASN Timing

For LTL and TL shipments, the ASN must be received by Northwind no later than 4 hours before the scheduled delivery appointment.

For parcel shipments, the ASN must be transmitted within 60 minutes after the parcel is tendered to the carrier.

2.3 ASN Content

Each carton listed in the ASN must be identified by a unique SSCC-18 that matches the SSCC printed on the carton label.

3 Carton Requirements

3.1 Dimensions and Weight

Cartons must fall within the limits below.

Attribute	Minimum	Maximum
Length	6 in	24 in
Width	4 in	18 in
Height	2 in	18 in

Weight	1 lb	45 lbs
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Cartons shipped via a parcel carrier must not exceed 35 lbs. This limit supersedes the table above for parcel shipments.

3.2 Inner Packs

Inner packs must contain a uniform quantity of units.

3.3 Carton Construction

Cartons must be corrugated with a minimum burst strength of 200 psi (ECT 32).

4 Labeling

4.1 Carton Labels

Every carton must carry a 4 in x 6 in GS1-128 shipping label containing a scannable SSCC-18 barcode.

The label must be placed on the longest side of the carton, in the lower right corner, no closer than 1.25 inches to any edge.

Labels must be legible and must not be placed over carton seams or covered with tape.

4.2 Pallet Labels

Each pallet must carry two pallet labels, formatted as specified in Section 4.1, affixed to two adjacent sides of the pallet.

5 Pallet Requirements

All LTL and TL shipments must be palletized on 40 x 48 inch GMA pallets.

Maximum pallet height is 72 inches (183 cm), including the pallet.

Pallets may not exceed 2,000 lbs gross weight.

Double-stacked pallets are accepted at all DCs except those listed in Appendix B.

6 Routing and Carrier Selection

6.1 Routing Requests

Shipments of 150 lbs or more must be routed through the Northwind Routing Portal at least 3 business days before the ship date.

6.2 Approved Carriers

Mode	Approved Carriers
Parcel	UPS, FedEx Ground
LTL	XPO, Old Dominion, Saia
TL	Assigned by the Northwind Routing Portal

7 Delivery Appointments

All LTL and TL deliveries require a scheduled appointment. Appointments must be requested at least 48 hours before the requested delivery time.

Carriers arriving more than 30 minutes after the appointment time will be refused.

8 Documentation

Each shipment must include a Bill of Lading (BOL) that references the Northwind PO number, and a packing list.

Shipments containing hazardous materials must include a Safety Data Sheet (SDS).

A commercial invoice is required for shipments originating outside the United States.

9 Chargeback Schedule

Violation	Section	Chargeback
Missing ASN	2.1	\$500 per shipment
Late ASN	2.2	\$300 per shipment
ASN / label SSCC mismatch	2.3	\$5.00 per carton
Carton outside dimension or weight limits	3.1	\$3.00 per carton
Missing or non-compliant carton label	4.1	\$2.50 per carton, \$250 minimum
Pallet size, height, or weight violation	5	\$75 per pallet
Unapproved carrier	6.2	3% of invoice value
Missed or unscheduled appointment	7	\$150 per occurrence
Missing BOL or packing list	8	\$100 per shipment

Repeat violations of the same type within a 90-day period are charged at 150% of the listed amount.

Appendix A Glossary

ASN: Advance Ship Notice, transmitted as EDI transaction set 856.

GMA pallet: Grocery Manufacturers Association standard 40 x 48 inch pallet.

SSCC-18: Serial Shipping Container Code, an 18-digit identifier encoded in a GS1-128 barcode.

Appendix B DC-Specific Requirements

DC 6012 (Reno, NV): Double-stacked pallets are not accepted. Maximum pallet height is 60 inches.

DC 6031 (Columbus, OH): Double-stacked pallets are not accepted. Deliveries are accepted Monday through Friday only.

DC 6040 (Dallas, TX): Maximum pallet height is 64 inches.